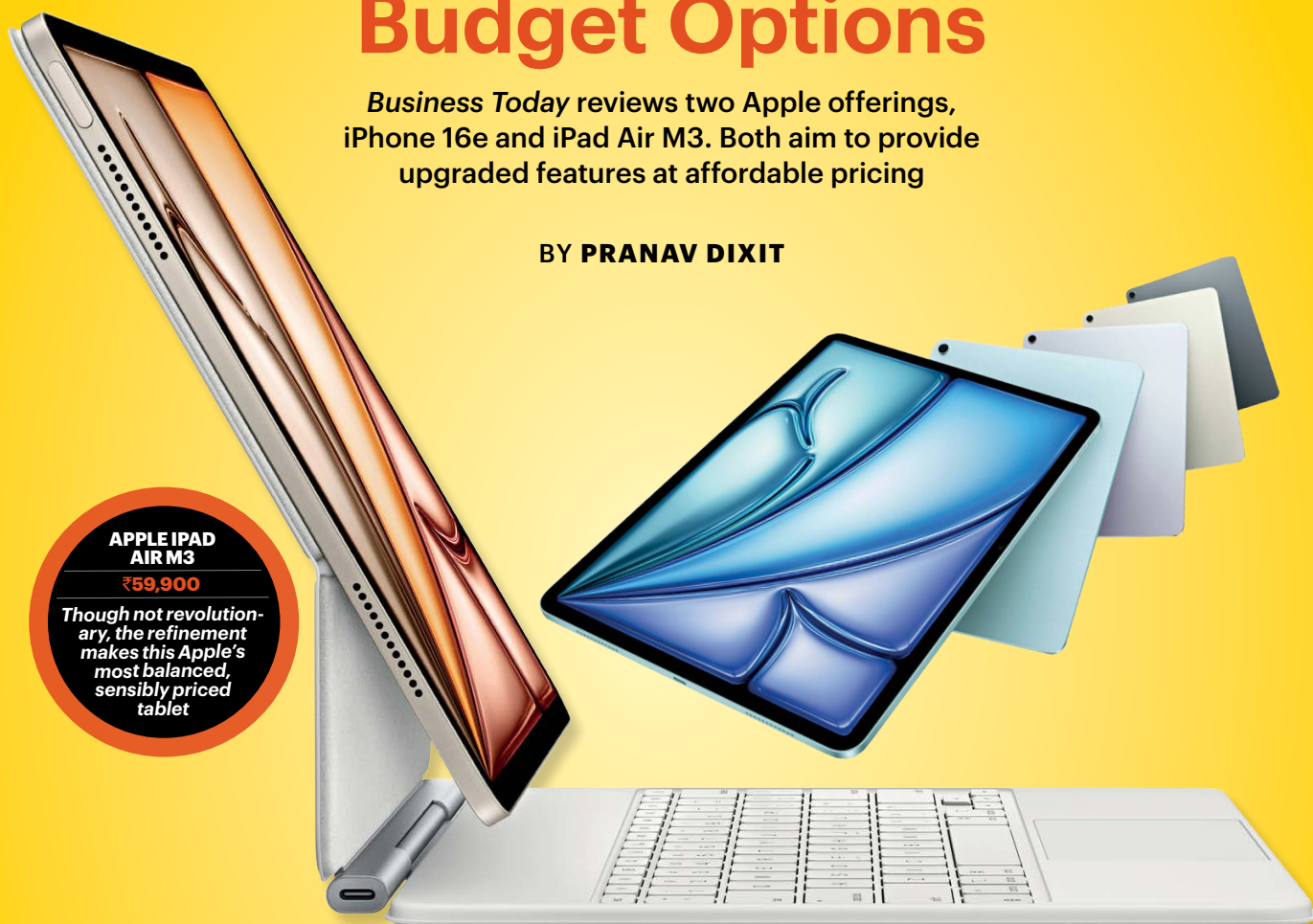


APPLE'S Budget Options

Business Today reviews two Apple offerings, iPhone 16e and iPad Air M3. Both aim to provide upgraded features at affordable pricing

BY PRANAV DIXIT



**APPLE IPAD
AIR M3**

₹59,900

Though not revolutionary, the refinement makes this Apple's most balanced, sensibly priced tablet

Familiar brilliance, incremental gains

LAST YEAR, Apple's iPad Air with the M2 chipset made a compelling argument that premium performance didn't have to mean breaking the bank on a Pro model. Now, the iPad Air returns with Apple's latest M3 chipset. At first glance, the iPad Air M3 feels disappointingly like its predecessor. But Apple's subtle refinements keep it comfortably positioned as the best-value "pro-lite" iPad you can buy right now. The design remains untouched with sleek aluminium edges, thin bezels, and familiar colour options. The brilliant 13-inch Liquid Retina LCD display still peaks at 600 nits with impressive clarity. However, deeper blacks and richer colours remain a Pro-exclusive perk.

Performance-wise, the jump from M2 to M3 isn't immediately

SPECIFICATIONS

Chip: Apple M3 with 8-core CPU & 9-core GPU **Display:** 11": 2,360 x 1,640, 500 nits 13": 2732 x 2048, 600 nits **RAM & Storage:** 8GB RAM; 128GB to 1TB **Cameras:** Rear: 12MP, 5x zoom, 4K video. Front: 12MP, center stage, 1,080p video